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Applying for: Technology Transfer and Commercialization Specialist, Western Michigan University, Kalamazoo, MI

SUMMARY

Commercialization infrastructure built for turning a university's invention portfolio into licenses and industry partnerships, not just filings. Built around the specialist function WMU's Innovation & Technology Advancement office runs: evaluating market potential, negotiating agreements, and fostering entrepreneurship, with the triage and matching work done before that time gets spent case by case.

RELEVANT EXPERIENCE

Invention Capture & Portfolio Buildout, Enveda Biosciences *Series B biotech · small legal team, high R&D velocity*

- Replaced a disclosure process engineers were quietly avoiding with AI-assisted intake that meets inventors where they already work: the direct equivalent of pulling patentable work out of engineers who don't recognize it as inventive.
- Migrated the full legacy portfolio in 30 minutes and became the IP team's system of record from day one, with no separate change-management project required.
- Gave a newly onboarded IP team member a working command center instead of a dependency on outside counsel for basic status checks, called “game-changing” from the first login.

Portfolio Strategy & Board Reporting, Woodward *industrial hardware manufacturer*

- Built patent-to-product mapping and board-ready KPI reporting for a hardware manufacturer transitioning off a legacy docketing system, the same “which three patents protect the core product” question every platform and prosecution effort ultimately has to answer.
- Selected over competing IPMS platforms specifically for configurability and fit with the client's existing product-lifecycle process, rather than for the AI drafting capability that later became the differentiator.

CORE CAPABILITIES MAPPED TO THIS ROLE

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- Commercialization-readiness triage: flags which inventions in the portfolio have real market demand versus which don't, the same call this role has to make before administering a data-use agreement or option negotiation.
 - Licensee and industry-partner discovery: a network of 20M licensing contacts with partner-specific outreach materials generated in about an hour, so evaluating market potential and finding an outside partner doesn't start from a cold list every time.
 - Portfolio and agreement tracking: tracks disclosures, IP status, and licensing activity in one place, the kind of visibility tied to as much as a 15% increase in licensing revenue at institutions using it, freeing time for the direct entrepreneur and faculty liaison work this role centers on.

WHERE I STOP

Negotiating the specific terms of an option or collaboration agreement, fostering entrepreneurship relationships in person, and the judgment call on which technology or founder is ready, that's relationship-building and judgment I don't have and don't claim to. What I can do is make sure the portfolio triage and industry-matching underneath those calls isn't the thing eating the hours that judgment needs.